



MALDIVES *Guide*

Know the Country:

Basic Details

- **Known as:** The Pearl of the Indian Ocean
- **Official Language:** Dhivehi
- **Also Known As:** Republic of Maldives
- **Currency:** Maldivian Rufiyaa (MVR)
- **Time Zone:** UTC+5 (Maldives Time)
- **Area:** 298 Square Kilometers (comprising over 1,190 islands)
- **Best Known For:** Private luxury resorts, overwater bungalows, pristine white-sand beaches, crystal-clear turquoise lagoons, world-class snorkeling and scuba diving.



Maldives **Visa**



Visa-Free Entry/Visa on Arrival for Indian Citizens

- **Visa Type:** Tourist Visa on Arrival
- **Eligibility:** Indian passport holders
- **Purpose:** Tourism, Family Visit, Short Stays
- **Duration:** Up to 30 days
- **Processing Time:** Visa is granted upon arrival at the airport, provided all documents are in order.

Documents Required at Entry Points:

- A valid passport with at least six months of validity from the date of arrival.
- A confirmed return or onward flight ticket.
- Proof of a confirmed hotel booking for your entire stay at a registered tourist facility.
- A completed Traveler Declaration Form, submitted electronically via the IMUGA website within 96 hours of travel.

The bustling capital city of Malé and its nightlife



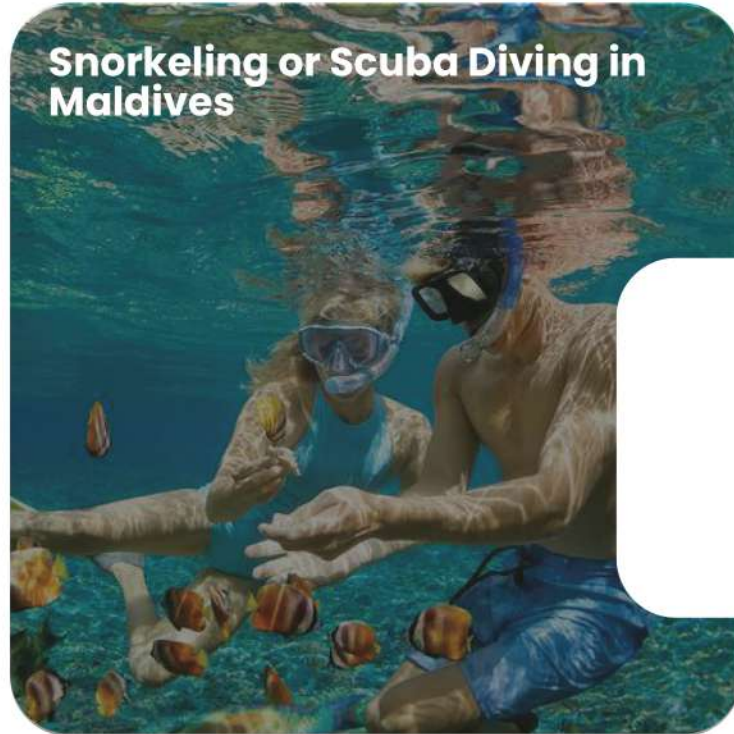
Indulge in luxurious couples Spa Treatments



Dine at an Underwater Restaurant in Maldives



Snorkeling or Scuba Diving in Maldives



ACTIVITIES IN *Maldives*

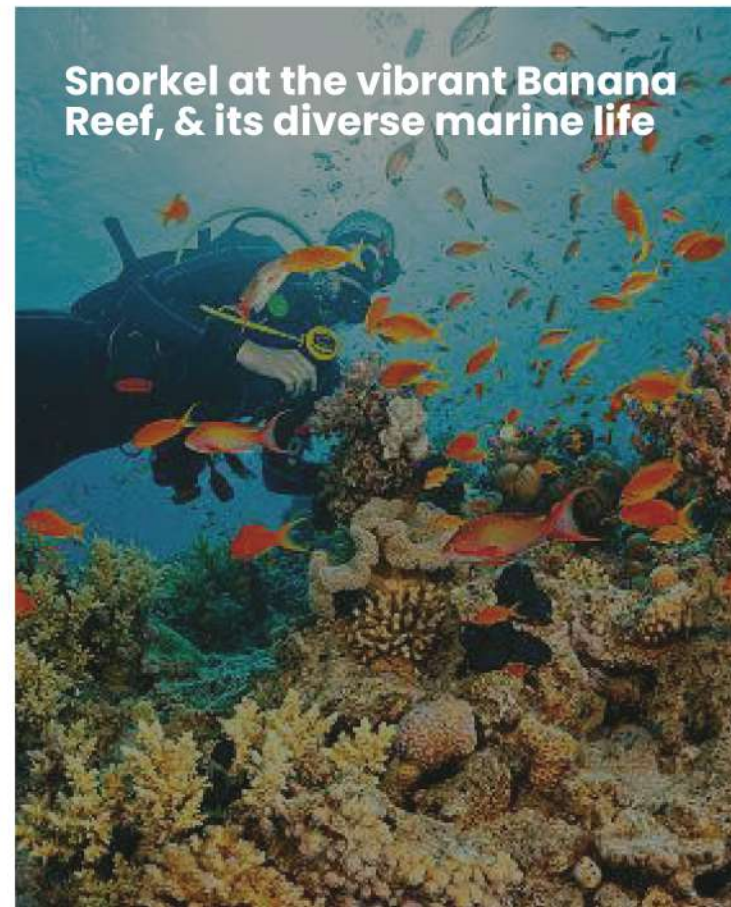
Walk along Vaadhoo Island's shoreline that glows at night



Enjoy a romantic sunset cruise on a traditional Dhoni boat



Snorkel at the vibrant Banana Reef, & its diverse marine life



Engage in water activities like jet skiing & parasailing



WHAT TO PACK FOR *Maldives?*

Essential Documents & Finances

- Passport
- Travel insurance documents
- Flight tickets
- Accommodation confirmation
- Copies of important documents (passport, Voter ID etc.)
- Credit/debit cards
- Local currency for immediate needs
- Emergency contact information

Sun & Insect Protection

- Sun hat
- Sunglasses (UV protection)
- Sunscreen (high SPF + reef safe)
- Insect repellent
- After-sun lotion or aloe vera gel
- Carry Rain Coat or Umbrella

Clothing & Footwear

- Lightweight and breathable clothes
- Swimwear (multiple pairs)
- Beach cover-ups or sarongs
- Casual evening wear for Dining
- Modest clothing for visiting local islands
- Flip-flops, sandals, or comfortable walking shoes
- Underwear and socks
- Towel

Health & Personal Care

- Prescribed medications
- First-aid kit.
- Personal toiletries
- Tooth Brush & Paste
- Hand sanitizer or wipes
- Lip balm with SPF
- Motion sickness medication

Travel & Practical Items

- Reusable water bottle
- Travel locks
- Ziplock bags
- Lightweight daypack
- Snacks
- Small travel towel
- Wet wipes
- Small notebook and pen
- Eye mask and earplugs
- Small flashlight or headlamp
- Collapsible shopping bag

Electronics & Gadgets

- Universal travel adapter.
- Power bank
- Camera/smartphone
- Chargers for all devices
- Waterproof phone pouch (for beach days)

SIM & Connectivity

- **International Roaming (India to Maldives):** While Indian providers like Airtel and Jio offer international roaming packs, local SIMs usually offer better value and more reliable network coverage.
- **Local SIM Cards:** Easily available at Velana International Airport (VIA) in Malé and from official telecom shops.
- **Get a Local SIM:** Dhiraagu and Ooredoo Maldives are the main providers. Both offer dedicated tourist SIM cards with various data and validity periods.
- **Network Recommendation:** Both Dhiraagu and Ooredoo offer excellent 4G/5G coverage, especially on the main inhabited islands and at resorts. You can purchase a SIM from kiosks right at the arrival terminal.

Dhiraagu Tourist SIM

615 MVR

20 GB Data + MVR 100 Credit

Validity: 10 Days

150 mins. Calls/150 SMS



Ooredoo Tourist SIM

616 MVR

20 GB Data + MVR 100 Credit

Validity: 01 Month

100 mins. Calls





The official currency is the Maldivian Rufiyaa (MVR or Rf).

Cash & Exchange

PRO TIPS FOR EXCHANGE

- Exchange **INR to USD in India**, then convert USD to local currency for better rates. Carry **500 USD in cash** for extra meals and activities not included in the itinerary.
- **Most resorts operate on a cashless system** where all expenses are charged to your room and settled upon checkout via credit card or in US dollars.
- **ATMs are available in Malé** and on some local islands.
- The **US Dollar is the unofficial second currency** and is widely accepted at resorts, guesthouses, and for tours.
- You will only **need local currency if you plan on visiting local islands** and buying from small shops or markets, where prices are often quoted in Rufiyaa.



Banknotes: MVR 5, 10, 20, 50, 100, 500, 1,000



Exchange Rate: ₹1 ≈ MVR 0.20 | MVR 1 ≈ ₹5.00

Fihunu Mas



Bis Keemiya



Mas Huni



Hedhikaa



FOOD IN *Maldives*



Garudhiya

Useful Phrases for Vegetarians in *Maldives*

Vegetarian – *Vegenun*

No fish – *Mas nuvee*

No eggs – *Dhi nuvee*

Do you have a vegetarian option? – *Miadhu ran'dhun kihineh?*

Ahannakee evves kahala janavaaru maheh nukaa meeheh. – I am a vegetarian.

Tharukaaree Kirugarudhiya



Boshi Mashuni



Dhonkeyo Kajuru

BEST FOOD IN *Maldives*

Malé

📍 Seagull Café

Try: Ice Cream, Nasi Goreng & Eggs Benedict

📍 Lazeez Gourmet

📍 **Try:** Middle Eastern Cuisine, Maalub, & Kebabs
Naga's Indian Restaurant

Try: Dum Biryani, Momo & Vegetarian Food



Phrases & Norms

While English is widely spoken at resorts, learning a few phrases in the local language, Dhivehi, is a great way to connect with locals.

English	Dhivehi	Pronunciation
Hello	Assalaamu Alaikum	Ah-sa-lah-moo ah-lay-koom
Thank you	Shukuriyaa	Shoo-koo-ree-yaa
Yes	Aan	Aan
No	Neiy	Nay
Excuse me / Sorry	Ma'afu kurey	Mah-foo koo-ray
Goodbye	Dhane	Dah-nay



Prohibited Items

The Maldives is a devout Muslim country with strict rules. Do not bring alcohol, pornographic materials, pork products or idols of worship among other things.



Stock Up

There are no grocery stores on these tiny private islands. So, shop for everything you need, including reef-safe sunscreen to help protect one of the Maldives' most precious natural habitats.



Dress

When visiting local islands, dress respectfully by covering your shoulders and knees. Bikinis and swimwear are restricted to private resort islands and designated "bikini beaches" on local islands.

Transportation

Seaplanes are the most iconic and scenic way to travel to resorts in distant atolls.

Seaplanes are small, propeller aircraft that take off and land on water, offering breathtaking aerial views of the coral reefs and scattered islands. They only operate during daylight hours (roughly 6:00 AM to 5:00 PM). If your international flight arrives after this time, you will need to book an overnight stay near the airport and take the seaplane the next morning. The main seaplane operators are Trans Maldivian Airways (TMA) and Manta Air.



Within Islands: Islands can be explored on foot. Larger local islands & Malé, have taxis, while some resorts offer bicycles for rent.



Speedboat

This is the most common form of transfer for resorts in the atolls closest to the main airport. It's a fast and efficient way to reach your destination.



Public Ferry

For budget travelers staying on local islands (like Maafushi or Thoddoo), public ferries are the best. You cannot book public ferries, purchase ticket directly at the ferry terminal



What to buy in *Maldives*?

Coconut Products

Bowls, ornaments, and other items crafted from coconut shells.



Thundu Kunaa

Hand-woven mats made from reeds, a traditional Maldivian craft.



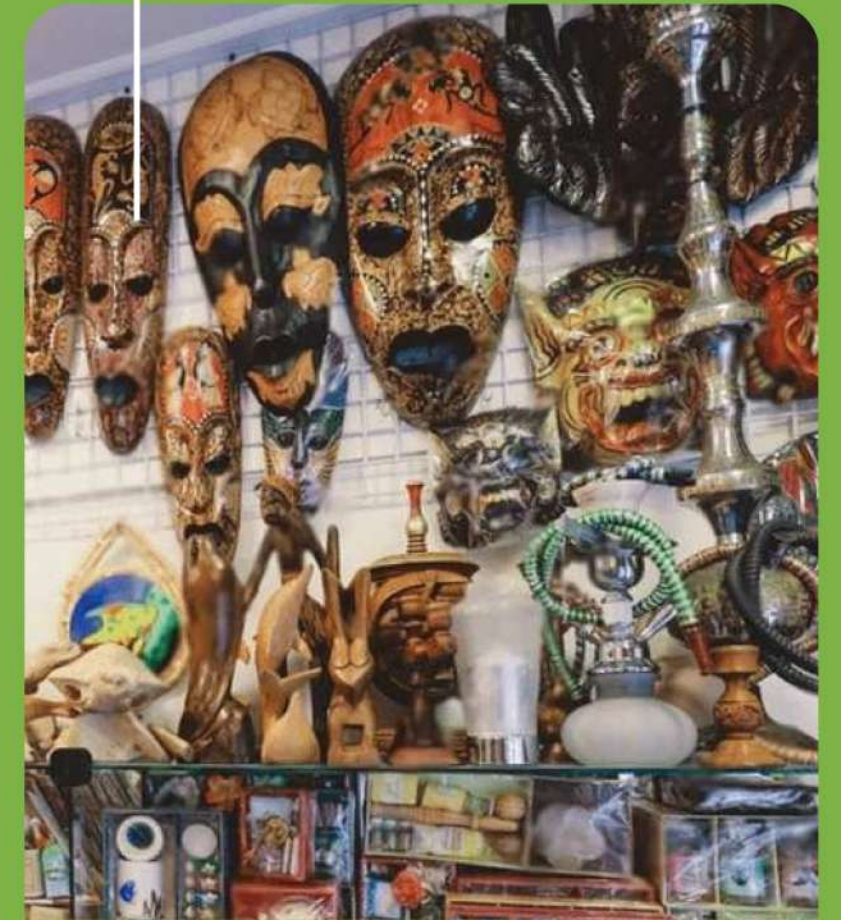
Sarongs and Apparel

Light, beach-friendly clothing & sarongs from local shops.



Local Handicrafts

Wooden lacquerware, woven mats, and small traditional dhoni boat models.



Know Before You Go!

- **Tropical Climate:** The Maldives enjoys a tropical climate with consistent warm temperatures and high humidity year-round. Average temperatures hover between 25°C and 32°C.
- **Safety & Health:** The Maldives is an extremely safe destination, particularly on private resort islands. Petty crime is rare.
- **Tap Water:** Tap water is not safe to drink. Always use bottled water for drinking, and for brushing your teeth.
- **Sun Protection:** The equatorial sun is very strong. Use a high-SPF, water-resistant reef-safe sunscreen, wear a hat and sunglasses, and stay hydrated to avoid dehydration and sunburn. Choosing a reef-safe sunscreen is a responsible way to contribute in protecting the delicate coral reefs of the Maldives.
- **Dress Code:** While swimwear is perfectly acceptable on private resort islands, it's crucial to dress modestly when visiting local islands. This means covering your shoulders and knees. Designated "bikini beaches" on local islands are the only places where Western swimwear is allowed.
- **Alcohol & Drugs:** The Maldives is a 100% Muslim country, and alcohol is strictly prohibited on all local islands. It is illegal to bring alcohol into the country, and any bottles in your luggage will be confiscated at the airport (and can be reclaimed on your departure for a fine). Alcohol is only served and consumed on private resort islands. Drug offenses carry extremely severe penalties.
- **Friday:** Friday is the holy day for Muslims. Expect a temporary pause in some local services and ferry operations during midday prayer times.

Happy Wraveling!

For assistance during your travels in Maldives, keep these important contacts handy:

- **Police:** 119
- **Ambulance:** 102
- **Fire Department:** 118

High Commission of India, Malé:

- **Address:** Lot No. 11499, Hithigas Magu, Hulhumale Phase-I, Maldives
- **Phone:** +960 4004176, +960 4004177
- **Website:** <https://hcimale.gov.in/>



GET IN TOUCH



The best adventures push you beyond your comfort zone into a world of wonder. Let this guide help you create incredible memories and if you want a trip where every detail is magic, **JustWraavel** has you covered. All you need to do is **live the adventure**.
Happy travels!



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